captivity of Shaybāni Khān and arrived in time when Babur needed his experience and expertise the most.

On the other hand, Auzun Hasan was feeling helpless after having his men captured in the citadel. Dejected, he decided to send off his most favoured retainers and serviceable braves to help his men in the citadel of Akhsi. They reached the brow of the river at the next dawn. The news of their arrival reached Babur right in time. His commanders and the Tashkent Moghūls decided to send a party of opposition as soon as possible. They crossed the river on the side of Andijān leaving away their horses on the other edge.

The men of Auzun were as nervous as their leader. In haste and hassle, they foolishly forgot to ferry the boat upstream. Consequently, they went right away from the landing place and could not cross the fort. They had to go downstream. To the surprise of Auzun's men, Babur's party began to ride bareback into the water from both the banks.

They could not fight back at all since they were stuck in the boat. But wickedness was an integral part of Azun in this case (as expressed by Babur in the *Baburnama*). One Qarlughach Bakhshi from their side called one of the Moghūl beg's sons to him and chopped him in pieces. Although Babur's men had no intention to wreak extreme havoc on those running on the boat, Bakhshi's act ensured that no mercy was shown to them.

Babur's men seized them all and no one was spared. Yet, Qarlughach Bakhshi and Khalil Diwan could escape while Qazi Ghulam and Sayyid Ali committed themselves to be Babur's slaves. Two of the major confidants of Auzun, Haidar-i-Quili, and Qilka Kashghari escaped. Among the eighty men, only six could get free. The news of this mishap did reach Auzun's and Tambal's ears. They knew that being straddled near Margilal would only bring misfortune for them. In Babur's words, they were badly scarred. In haste, with the remaining sparse men, both began to march towards Andijān. Their troop was highly disordered and disorganized. Just to have someone as a precautionary step, Auzun decided to leave Nasir Beg (the husband of his sister). He was indeed a brave man with abundant experience under his belt. But even his presence could not make much difference. Auzun and Tambal had lost it completely and Andijān seemed to be slipping out of their hands.

Smelling defeat, Auzun Hasan rode back to Akhsi to his wife, while Tambal rode to Osh. Jahangir Mīrzā and many from his household fled,